MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CUTTER, STRAP

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This strap cutter covered by this specification is for use in packaging and shipping containers for ammunition items (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-48078 - Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification for

FEDERAL

QQ-Z-325 - Zinc Coated Electrodeposited, Requirements for

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipping and Storage
MIL-STD-171 - Finishing of Metal and Wood Surfaces

FSC: 8140

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

DRAWINGS

ARMY

9297887 - Cutter, Strap

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Other publications.-The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-E18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials
ASTM-B117 - Salt Spray (Fog) Testing

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Stree, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, 19103).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.-Materials and parts shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Salt Spray (Fog) Test.-The protective finish shall meet the requirements of finish No. 1.9.2.3 of MIL-STD-171, when tested as specified in 4.5.2.

3.3 Workmanship.-All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated and finished in a thorough workmanlike manner, and all manufacturing and processing shall be correctly performed. They shall be clean and free of burrs, sharp edges, unblended radii, surface defects, chips, dirt, grease and oil, corrosion products and other foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any part or assembly nor shall they be contaminated by the cleaning agent. Exterior coatings shall be continuous except for a few light scratches not exposing base material. All required marking shall be neat and sharply defined.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 First Article Inspection.-This specification makes provisions for first article inspection. Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for Inspection and Standard Quality Assurance Provisions.-Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this detail specification.

4.2 Classification of Inspections.-The following types of inspection shall be conducted on this item:

a. First Article Inspection (see 4.3)
b. Quality Conformance Inspection (see 4.4)

4.3 First Article Inspection

4.3.1 Submission.-The contractor shall submit a first article sample (see 6.2), as designated by the Contracting Officer, for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.3.2. The first article sample shall consist of ten (10) complete sets of parts (including at least five (5) items from each tool used to produce stamped parts and be so identified as to permit tracing each item to the tool in which it was stamped).

4.3.2 Inspections to be performed.-See MIL-A-48078.

4.3.3 Rejection.-See MIL-A-48078.

4.4 Quality Conformance Inspection

4.4.1 Inspection Lot Formation.-Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provision of MIL-A-48078.

4.4.2 Examination.-(The requirements of this paragraph apply to those dimensions which are considered "as stamped", and which do not undergo subsequent operations). In place of the normal sampling associated with the Classification of Defects, and with the approval of the Contracting Officer, a sample of at least five (5) parts shall be dimensionally inspected to qualify the tool used in the stamping

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

process for use in production. In addition, a random sample of three (3) parts shall be selected from the last hour of each eight (8) hours of production for dimensional inspection as a control of the tool used during production. As a control of each tool during production, the above quantity of parts shall be inspected for at least the defects listed in paragraphs 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2. If any defective parts are found during qualification of the tool, the tool producing the defective part shall not be used in production. If any defective parts are found when inspection is performed for control of the tool, the tool producing the defective part shall be removed from production.Further, that portion of production since the last tool control check shall be returned to the contractor for corrective action or for inspection for each separate type of defect according to MIL-STD-105, using an AQL of 0.40 percent for each major defect and an AQL of 0.65 percent for each minor defect. When production is resumed, at least five (5), parts shall be dimensional inspected for the above requirements for qualification. All tools removed from production because of some fault, may, after reworking,be returned to production providing they pass the qualification test above. The contractor may request a change of inspection frequency providing he presents objective evidence to the Contracting Officer to substantiate the request.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9297887-1
4.4.2.1	Handle				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION
Critical	None defined				
Major B					
101.	Largest outside width, minimum			3.1	Gage
102.	Outside width of large end			3.1	Gage
103.	Height of bent edge at large end			3.1	Gage
104.	Distance between traverse holes			3.1	Gage
105.	Length from small end to traverse holes			3.1	Gage
106.	Width of wire cutting slot, at open end, min.			3.1	Gage
107.	Angle from large end, to base			3.1	Gage
Minor					
201.	Evidence of poor workmanship			3.3	Visual
202.	Diameter of six small holes			3.1	Gage

NOTES:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.2	Cutter				9297887-2
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION
Critical	None defined				
Major B					
101.	Large inside width			3.1	Gage
102.	Distance from tip of point to back			3.1	Gage
103.	Radius of bend in arm (open end)			3.1	Gage
104.	Inside length of arm			3.1	Gage
Minor					
20.1	Evidence of poor workmanship			3.3	Visual

NOTES:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3 Testing

4.4.3.1 Hardness of cutter (see dwg. 9297887) - Major Defect B.-A sample of 10 (ten) cutters shall be selected from each heat treated batch for this test. If any cutter fails to meet the requirement, the heat treated batch shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.5.1.

4.4.3.2 Salt Spray (Fog)Test.-The strap cutters shall be sampled as specified in the applicable sampling paragraph of QQ-Z-325, using an AQL of 2.5 percent.

4.4.4 Inspection Equipment.-The inspection equipment required to perform the inspections prescribed in this specification is identified in the examination (4.4.2) and Test Methods (4.5) paragraphs herein. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and 6.3 herein.

4.5 Test Methods and Procedures.-(see 6.4)

4.5.1 Hardness of Cutter.-The cutters shall be tested for hardness in accordance with ASTM-E18.

4.5.2 Salt Spray (Fog) Test.-The salt spray test shall be performed in accordance with ASTM-B117. The strap cutters shall be exposed to the salt spray for a period of 96 hours, minimum.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing

5.1.1 Level C.-Unless otherwise specified, packing shall be in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice to assure acceptance by common carrier for safe delivery at first destination for immediate use. The carrying weight of the shipping containers shall not exceed approximately 120 pounds.

5.2 Marking.-Unless otherwise specified, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended Use.-The strap cutter covered by this specification are intend for use in cutting metal bands and straps in order to open shipping containers for ammunition items.

6.2 Ordering Data.-See MIL-A-48078.

6.3 Submission of Inspection Equipment Designs for Approval.-See MIL-A-48078. Submit equipment designs, as required, to Commander, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SARPA-QA-T, Dover, New Jersey 07801.

6.4 Prior approval of the Contracting Officer is required for use of equivalent test methods. A description of the proposed method should be submitted through the Contracting Officer to: Commander, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SARPA-QA-A-P, Dover, New Jersey 07801. This description should include but not be limited to the accuracy and precision of the method, test data to demonstrate the accuracy and precision and drawings of any special equipment required.

Custodian:
Army-PA

Preparing Activity:
Army-PA

Project Number: 8140-A137

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.